Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH **0500/01**

Paper 1 Reading **For examination from 2027**

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 80

Converted

This mark scheme accompanies a converted question paper: Cambridge IGCSE First Language English 0500/12 February/March 2025, restructured to the 2027–2029 Paper 1 format. The reading texts in the insert are unchanged.

Where a question has been carried over, the indicative content is transferred unchanged, because the text has not changed and the creditable points have not changed. Questions marked **generated** are new and their indicative content has been written for this conversion.

Level descriptor tables are reproduced unchanged from the official 2027 specimen mark scheme (0500/01/SP/27). Conversion decisions are recorded in the note on page 4.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Generic Marking Principles

All examiners must apply these general marking principles when marking candidate responses. Examiners must apply them alongside the specific content of the mark scheme or generic level descriptions for a question. Each question paper and mark scheme must also comply with these marking principles.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 1:

Marks must be awarded in line with:

- the specific content of the mark scheme or the generic level descriptions for the question
- the specific skills defined in the mark scheme or in the generic level descriptions for the question
- the standard of response required by a candidate as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 2:

Marks awarded are always whole marks (not half marks, or other fractions).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 3:

Marks must be awarded positively:

- marks are awarded for correct/valid answers, as defined in the mark scheme. However, credit is given for valid answers which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme, referring to your Team Leader as appropriate
- marks are awarded when candidates clearly demonstrate what they know and can do
- marks are not deducted for errors
- marks are not deducted for omissions
- answers should only be judged on the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar when these features are specifically assessed by the question as indicated by the mark scheme. The meaning, however, should be unambiguous.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 4:

Rules must be applied consistently, e.g. in situations where candidates have not followed instructions or in the application of generic level descriptions.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 5:

Marks should be awarded using the full range of marks defined in the mark scheme for the question (however, the use of the full mark range may be limited according to the quality of the candidate responses seen).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 6:

Marks awarded are based solely on the requirements as defined in the mark scheme. Marks should not be awarded with grade thresholds or grade descriptions in mind.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

English & Media-Specific Marking Principles

(To be read in conjunction with the Generic Marking Principles (and requiring further guidance on how to place marks within levels))

Components using level descriptions:

- We use level descriptions as a guide to broad understanding of the qualities normally expected of, or typical of, work in a level.
- Level descriptions are a means of general guidance, and should not be interpreted as hurdle statements.
- Where indicative content notes are supplied for a question, these are not a prescription of required content, and must not be treated as such. Alternative correct points and unexpected answers in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the knowledge and skills demonstrated.
- While we may have legitimate expectations as to the ground most answers may occupy, we must at all times be prepared to meet candidates on their chosen ground, provided it is relevant ground (e.g. clearly related to and derived from a relevant passage/text and meeting the mark scheme requirements for the question).

Components using point-based marking:

Point marking is often used to reward knowledge, understanding and application of skills. We give credit where the candidate's answer shows relevant knowledge, understanding and application of skills in answering the question. We do not give credit where the answer shows confusion.

From this it follows that we:

a DO credit answers which are worded differently from the mark scheme if they clearly convey the same meaning (unless the mark scheme requires a specific term).

b DO credit alternative answers/examples which are not written in the mark scheme if they are correct.

c DO credit answers where candidates give more than one correct answer in one prompt/numbered/scaffolded space where extended writing is required rather than list-type answers. For example, questions that require n reasons (e.g. State two reasons …).

d DO NOT credit answers simply for using a 'key term' unless that is all that is required. (Check for evidence it is understood and not used incorrectly.)

e DO NOT credit answers which are obviously self-contradicting or trying to cover all possibilities.

f DO NOT give further credit for what is effectively repetition of a correct point already credited unless the language itself is being tested. This applies equally to 'mirror statements' (i.e. polluted/not polluted).

g DO NOT require spellings to be correct, unless this is part of the test. However spellings of syllabus terms must allow for clear and unambiguous separation from other syllabus terms with which they may be confused (e.g. Corrasion/Corrosion).

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Notes on this converted mark scheme

Question 1 order. Sub-parts run in the order of their anchors in Text A. Both generated items anchor to ¶3 and are grouped under 1(d): (i) the effect of 'Astonished' (R4) and (ii) why tagging a zebra is 'no easy task' (R3). They sit before the carried ¶3–4 pair, which becomes 1(e); old 1(e) on ¶5 becomes 1(f). Six letters, (a)–(f).

Question 3 mark split. This paper follows the specimen allocation exactly: 3(a) 2 × 1, 3(b) 3 × 1, 3(c) 5, 3(d) 10, totalling 20.

The source 2(a) carried four one-mark identification items and the 2027 3(a) has room for two. 2(a)(ii) (R2) and 2(a)(iii) (R1), preserving source order and spanning both implicit and explicit retrieval as the specimen 3(a) does. The items not carried forward are:

- 2(a)(i) — 'inexpensive' – 'cheap' (line 8) (R1)
- 2(a)(iv) — 'rejoin each other' – 'merge (together)' (lines 31–32) (R1)

Question 3(d). The 2027 language task prints a single extract and names a specific focus, where the source 2(d) referenced two paragraphs. Kept: Text C paragraph 13 ('Months later …'), 13 indicative points. Dropped: Text C paragraph 1 ('I'm watching …'), 10 indicative points, dropped with the move to a single extract.

Table substitutions. Tables A, B, C, D, E, F and G below are taken unchanged from the official 2027 specimen mark scheme 0500/01/SP/27. No table has been reworded or rescaled.

Generated questions. 1(d(i)), 1(d(ii)), 2(b) are new to this conversion. Each was tested for answerability against the insert alone before its indicative content was written. 2(b) targets the writer's attitude, so it cannot be answered from content already creditable in the 2(a) summary.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 1

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2, R3, R4 and R5 (20 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

R4 demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

Overview of items for Question 1

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
1(a)	R5	1
1(b)(i)	R1	2
1(b)(ii)	R1	2
1(c)	R1	2
1(d)(i)	R4 *(generated)*	2
1(d)(ii)	R3 *(generated)*	3
1(e)(i)	R1 and R5	2
1(e)(ii)	R1, R2 and R5	3
1(f)	R1 and R2	3
Total		**20**

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
1(a)	**Give two examples of animals which migrate (other than humpback whales) according to paragraph 1.** Award 1 mark for both responses. • Monarch butterflies • European swallows	1
1(b)(i)	**Using your own words, explain what the text means by: 'incredible endurance' (line 5).** Award 2 marks for full explanation (both strands). Award 1 mark for partial explanation. Credit alternatives explaining the whole phrase. • extraordinary / amazing / unbelievable / extreme / great • stamina / tolerance / sticking with something / resilience / keep(ing) going / tenacity / resistance to fatigue / (capacity for) maintaining strength	2
1(b)(ii)	**Using your own words, explain what the text means by: 'facilitated research' (line 7).** Award 2 marks for full explanation (both strands). Award 1 mark for partial explanation. Credit alternatives explaining the whole phrase. • made easier / helped (bring about) / made more possible / allowed more / aided / enabled • study(ing) / finding out about / investigating	2
1(c)	**Reread paragraph 2 ('Despite … animal movement.'). Give two ways in which migration differs from other types of animal movement.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to maximum of 2. • (involves a) return journey • (happens) season(ally)	2
1(d)(i)	**Reread paragraph 3 ('Astonished … wasn't clear.'). Explain the effect of the word 'Astonished' (line 11) at the start of the paragraph.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 2. • shows the scientists were amazed / stunned / could hardly believe it – a stronger reaction than simply being interested or surprised • signals that the discovery was completely unexpected – even experts had no idea zebras could travel so far • placing it first, before 'scientists', gives the sentence a dramatic opening and makes the finding sound important / newsworthy • implies existing knowledge of zebras was wrong / incomplete, so the reader is invited to share the surprise	2
1(d)(ii)	**Reread paragraph 3 ('Astonished … wasn't clear.'). Using your own words, explain why the writer describes tagging a wild zebra as 'no easy task' (line 14).** Award 1 mark for each idea, predominantly in own words, up to a maximum of 3. • the animals are wild and will not let people near them / are unpredictable • they are dangerous – one blow from a hoof is powerful enough to kill even a large predator, so researchers risk serious injury or death • the zebra has first to be drugged and made calm, which is an extra stage before any work can begin • the researcher must get physically close to attach the collar, and must do so accurately while the animal is subdued • the process had to be repeated with eight separate animals	3

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
1(e)(i)	**Reread paragraphs 3 and 4 ('Astonished … GPS-tagged zebras.'). Identify two things scientists had to do before they were able to study how far the plains zebras travelled during migration.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to maximum of 2. • sedate them • tag them / fit satellite trackers (to zebras)	2
1(e)(ii)	**Reread paragraphs 3 and 4 ('Astonished … GPS-tagged zebras.'). Explain what researchers in the second study did to test what might influence the direction in which migrating zebras travelled.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 3. • Used / created computer simulations • Looked at two theories / considered perception and sense and considered memory • Compare (the simulated tracks) with the real zebras / compare with the GPS data	3
1(f)	**Reread paragraph 5 ('Preliminary … lead scientist.'). Using your own words, explain why some people might not accept the findings of the study as conclusive.** Award 1 mark for each idea, predominantly in own words, up to a maximum of 3. Answers which are entirely in the words of the text should not be credited. • only described as 'preliminary' / need more monitoring • (memory) predicts only 'more accurately', not exactly • did not consider effect of predators • tracking data suggests it is neither model / might be genetic / tracking data may be unreliable / models might be flawed • lead scientist agrees they don't know for sure	3

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 2

Question 2(a) tests the following reading assessment objectives (10 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

This question also tests the following writing assessment objectives (5 marks):

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 organise and structure facts, ideas and opinions for effect

W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context.

Question 2(b) tests the following reading assessment objectives (5 marks):

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text.

Overview of items for Question 2

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
2(a)	R1, R2 and R5	10
	W1, W2 and W3	5
2(b)	R2 and R3 *(generated)*	5
Total		**20**

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
2(a)	**According to Text B, what are the reasons why changes to animal migrations have occurred and why are these changes worrying? You must use continuous writing (not note form) and use your own words as far as possible. Your summary should not be more than 120 words. Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 2(a) (Table A, Reading and Table B, Writing). **INDICATIVE READING CONTENT** Candidates may refer to any of the points below: • food in landfills distracts them / junk food offers easier feeding option • global warming • migration guards against parasites • urbanisation / expansion of cities / increased infrastructure • habitat divided / manmade barriers • efforts to solve the problem aren't working / attempts to re-establish routes have failed / does not appear to be reversible • affects ecosystem (in destination/Africa) • increased competition for resources for resident non-migratory species • (lose) research generated by migration / will learn less about human behaviour • species in decline • deforestation / destruction of stopover sites	15

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Marking criteria for Question 2(a)

Table A, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R5.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• An effective response that demonstrates understanding of a wide range of relevant ideas and is consistently well-focused on the text and task. • Relevant ideas are skilfully selected to demonstrate an overview.
4	7–8	• A mostly effective response that demonstrates a competent understanding of a good range of relevant ideas and is consistently well-focused on the text and task. • Relevant ideas are carefully selected and there is some evidence of an overview.
3	5–6	• A partially effective response that demonstrates understanding of a range of relevant ideas with occasional loss of focus on text or task. • Some evidence of selection of relevant ideas but may include excess material.
2	3–4	• A basic response that demonstrates general understanding of relevant ideas and is sometimes focused on text and task. • Some indiscriminate selection of ideas.
1	1–2	• A response that demonstrates limited understanding of relevant ideas and shows limited focus on text and task. • Little evidence of selection of ideas.
0	0	No creditable content.

Table B, Writing

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Writing. This question tests assessment objectives W1, W2 and W3.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	• Expression is clear and fluent. • Organisation is effective. • Concise use of a range of appropriate vocabulary.
2	2–3	• Expression is generally clear. • Organisation is sometimes effective. • Areas of concision but some reliance on the words of the text.
1	1	• Expression lacks clarity. • Organisation is limited. • Includes lifted sections.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
2(b)	**Assess the writer's attitude towards the research into animal migration and the book in which it is presented. Use three details from Text B to support your answer.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 2(b) (Table C, Reading). Responses might use the following: • impressed / astonished by the book (para 1): 'mind-blowing maps' is hyperbolic praise, and 'one shocking example' shows he finds the findings startling rather than merely interesting • regards the research as urgent, not optional (para 2): the evaluative 'there's a new urgency in such research' presents the work as pressing because global warming is already altering routes • enthusiastic about what technology now makes possible (para 2): 'Nowadays, technology allows us to monitor' with the casual aside 'say, a herd of elephants or a flock of storks' conveys easy confidence in the scale of what can now be tracked • values the research very highly (para 5): the absolute adjective in 'the invaluable research generated by animal migration' claims a worth that cannot be measured • intrigued by the unexpected reach of the findings (para 5): the parenthetical comparison of baboons' group movements with 'crowd behaviour of human commuters' shows he relishes research that illuminates people as well as animals	5

Table C, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R2 and R3.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	Clear understanding of the writer's attitude with relevant support from the text.
2	2–3	Some understanding of the writer's attitude with some supporting detail.
1	1	Limited understanding of the writer's attitude.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 3

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4 (20 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R4 demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers.

Overview of items for Question 3

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
3(a)(i)	R2	1
3(a)(ii)	R1	1
3(b)(i)	R2	1
3(b)(ii)	R2	1
3(b)(iii)	R2	1
3(c)	R1, R2 and R4	5
3(d)	R1, R2 and R4	10
Total		**20**

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(a)(i)	**Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words in bold:** **Seeing the flashing signals on the computer screen stops Lotta worrying that the trackers will not work.** Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer. • blinking (red lights) (line 13)	1
3(a)(ii)	**Even though there are still a few bird species left alive, there is no longer any money available to pay for scientists to study them.** Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer. • some birds remain (line 23)	1
3(b)(i)	**Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words in bold:** 'I've put trackers on three, but couldn't afford cameras,' I explain, doggedly following Ennis back to his **vessel**. 'They'll only help to **pinpoint** where the birds fly. Someone needs to **witness** how they survive, to learn. Take me south – we'll follow them. If there are fish left, those birds will find them.' **vessel** • ship / boat / craft	1
3(b)(ii)	**pinpoint** • highlight / show the exact place / locate / indicate the position / target the place they end up	1
3(b)(iii)	**witness** • observe / take note of / see (the evidence) / watch / look (at) / view / personally experience	1

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(c)	**Use one example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests Lotta's attitude to the project. Use your own words in your explanation.** I'm not sure when dreaming of this last desperate project began, but it's part of me now as much as the instinct for breath. It swallowed me whole – a fantasy quest, securing a place on a fishing vessel and having its captain carry me far south following the longest natural migration of any living creature. Use the Marking Criteria for Question 3(c) (Table D, Reading). The explanation must be predominantly in the candidate's own words. Responses might use the following: • dreaming of this last desperate project: has imagined it repeatedly in her sleep / thoughts; final attempt; chances of it working are slim • it's part of me now as much as the instinct for breath: like breathing so has no choice but to do it; important to her; essential for life; cannot forget it or remove it from her thoughts; natural urge • It swallowed me whole – a fantasy quest: heroic undertaking/adventure that took over her thoughts; completely consumed by the idea; suggests she is fanatical / driven; comes at a cost to her own well-being/comfort; it is going to be difficult and dangerous, though exciting; searching for a great prize / something that may not even exist	5

Table D, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	Clear understanding of the writer's use of language.
2	2–3	Some understanding of the writer's use of language.
1	1	Limited understanding of the writer's use of language.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(d)	**Choose three powerful words or phrases from the extract below to analyse how the writer uses language to describe what Ennis and Lotta find at the end of their journey.** 'Months later, the remote shore ahead is magnificent – but empty. I'd told myself it was over when the signals stopped after the last storm; still somehow I'd hoped to see birds, or something, anything, alive. The boat can go no further, so we continue on foot towards the ridge – the only movement anywhere. My heart breaks and then jumps … because something just flew across the sky. More somethings appear, swooping and soaring. I scramble to the summit and – oh, hundreds of terns smother an expanse of unspoiled ice below. Yet more dance upon the air. Dipping gracefully, diving hungrily, in a bay bubbling and thrashing with a million scales. Ennis reaches me with a low rumble of laughter, just as a huge whale fin crowns the sparkling surface. We gasp. What else is hiding in these clean, untouched waters – this sanctuary?' Write about 200 to 250 words. Use the Marking Criteria for Question 3(d) (Table E, Reading). **Notes on the task** This question is marked for the ability to select powerful or unusual words and for an understanding of ways in which the language is effective. Expect responses to provide words / phrases that carry connotations additional to general meaning. Mark holistically for the overall quality of the response, not for the number of words chosen, bearing in mind that for the higher bands there should be a range of choices to demonstrate an understanding of how language works, and that this should include the ability to explain images. It is the quality of the analysis that attracts marks. Do not deduct marks for inaccurate statements; simply ignore them. Candidates can make any sensible comment, but only credit those that are relevant to the correct meanings of the words in the context and that have some validity. Alternative acceptable explanations should be credited. Credit comments on effects created by non-vocabulary choices such as grammar / syntax and punctuation devices. These must be additional to comments on vocabulary. Only credit comments on stylistic effect where these are explicitly linked to choices.	10

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(d)	Responses might focus on words or phrases from the following: • magnificent – but empty: amazing landscape; raises hope, but there is nothing to be seen; should contain flora and fauna • something, anything, alive: wants to see any living creature, or organism; desperation • my heart breaks and then jumps …: gives up again – had hope again in landing – followed by sudden realisation that she's seen something; despair followed by excitement • something just flew across the sky: has seen a bird; cannot believe it; can't tell what creature it was / dare not name it; startled • More somethings appear, swooping and soaring: flying upwards and downwards powerfully; still indistinct/in the distance/high up; knows these are birds now but not yet revealing/admitting that; appear to be enjoying themselves • I scramble to the summit: inelegant, hasty climb to the top of the ridge; childish eagerness to see over • hundreds of terns smother an expanse of unspoiled ice below: release of emotion at the quantity of birds she can see completely covering the frozen land; perfect, pristine, still frozen/glacier/not destroyed by humans (yet) • dance upon the air: huge quantities of terns flying joyfully (contrast with the three); turning and twisting movements; performance • Dipping gracefully, diving hungrily: they have found fish so are keen to eat them; subtle elegant movements combined with direct straight downwards movement to catch their prey; awe at prowess • a bay bubbling and thrashing with a million scales: abundance of fish; energetic movement of so many healthy fish in the water makes it look like it is boiling; contrast with initial emptiness of the shore / panic of the prey • a low rumble of laughter: deep throaty sound showing satisfaction, pleasure at finding life here; possibility of fishing again; in sync with the whale • a huge whale fin crowns the sparkling surface: evidence of a large sea creature coming above the clear glistening water; regal; beautiful; magical • What else is hiding in these clean, untouched waters – this sanctuary?: safe place; not polluted; somewhere creatures are protected; mysterious; potential to find more; ends dramatically on a cliffhanger	

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Marking Criteria for Question 3(d)

Table E, Reading: Analysing how writers achieve effects

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• Analysis adds meaning and associations to precisely selected words/phrases and demonstrates the writer's reasons for using them. • Explains images with some precision and imagination. • Clear understanding of the writer's use of language.
4	7–8	• Some analysis of carefully selected words and phrases offers secure explanations of meanings within the context of the text. • Begins to identify and explain images. • Some understanding of the writer's use of language.
3	5–6	• Chooses appropriate words and phrases. • Mostly explains meanings of words. • Attempts to suggest and explain effects are basic or general.
2	3–4	• Chooses words and phrases that communicate less effectively within the context of the text. • Explanations repeat the language of the original and/or are general, slight or only partially effective. • Correctly identifies linguistic devices.
1	1–2	• Choice of words is rarely relevant. • Comments offer limited evidence of understanding.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 4

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2, R3 and R5 (10 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

and writing assessment objectives W1, W2, W3 and W4 (10 marks):

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 organise and structure facts, ideas and opinions for effect

W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context

W4 use language appropriate to audience and purpose.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
4	**You are a journalist. You have interviewed Ennis and Lotta months after they have returned from their trip. You write a magazine article about Lotta's research project and the conservation work they are both now involved in.** **In your article, you should:** • **describe what Lotta did to prepare for the research project and the challenges Lotta faced** • **explain why Lotta needed Ennis's help with the project and why Ennis decided to help Lotta** • **explain how Ennis and Lotta felt about what happened on their journey and the changes they hope to bring about in the future.** **Write the words of the article.** **Base your article on what you have read in Text C, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullets.** **Write about 250 to 300 words.** **Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to 10 marks for writing.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 4 (Table F, Reading and Table G, Writing). **Notes on the task** Candidates should select ideas from the text (see below) and develop them relevantly, supporting what they write with details from the text. Look for an appropriate register for the genre, and a clear and balanced response which covers the three areas of the question, is well sequenced, and is in the candidate's own words. Annotate A1 for references to what Lotta did to prepare for the research project and the challenges she faced. Annotate A2 for references to why Lotta needed Ennis's help with the project and why he decided to help her. Annotate A3 for references to how Ennis and Lotta felt about what happened on their journey and the changes they hope to bring about in the future.	20

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
4	**A1: describe what Lotta did to prepare for the research project and the challenges Lotta faced** • Catch the birds (det. basket trap; only found/caught three) [dev. can be aggressive / nervous creatures] • Putting trackers on the birds (det. lightweight, need to be quick, plastic fastener) [dev. difficult / skilful / practice / not affect(ing) the birds] • Planning / previous study (det. mapped routes the birds have taken, software, laptop, scientist, notes) [dev. identified patterns in birds' behaviour] • Camping at the cliff (det. tent blown away, outside in the wild for days) [dev. cold / uncomfortable] • Rental car (det. cheap, remote area) [dev. no public transport / needs to carry equipment / too far to walk] • Money (det. no longer funding for research) [dev. has had to finance this trip herself / does not know how long she can go on for] **A2: explain why Lotta needed Ennis's help with the project and why Ennis decided to help Lotta** • Find fish (det. birds will show where the fish are) [dev. misses his way of life / misses the fish(ing) / wants to know if fish still exist / Lotta offers him hope] • No cameras (det. trackers only pinpoint where the birds are) [dev. need to be able to see what the birds are doing] • Transport / boat (det. (captain of) Raven, birds fly south for the winter) [dev. fulfilling a dream / needs to follow across water / experienced navigator] • Interested in birds (det. want to know how they survive, last colony) [dev. impressed by the birds' endurance / affinity with movement across the ocean] • Lotta's tenacity (det. finds him in the café, spent the night on the harbour, followed him back to the boat) [dev. recognises Lotta's passion for the project / convinced by Lotta / resurrects his own passions] **A3: explain how Ennis and Lotta felt about what happened on their journey and the changes they hope to bring about in the future** • Storm (det. signals stopped) [dev. scary / thought the birds had died] • Initial disappointment on arrival at the ice-face (det. no sign of life after months of travel) [dev. devastating / lowest point / lost all hope] • Have to walk (det. can get no further by boat) [dev. don't want to give up / still hoping for something / boat damaged by the journey] • Found terns (det. sees one, then hundred; colony) [dev. feeding on fish / thriving] • Whale (det. huge, laughter as fin appears) [dev. thought there were no more / believed to be extinct / other species may not be extinct after all] • Large bay (det. clean, untouched waters, unspoiled ice) [dev. thrilled / hugely significant discovery / seemed unreal / hope for the future / may be other discoveries] • Commitment to protecting what is left / repopulating areas (det. learn from their experience) [dev. education / need to listen to scientists and act / continue research / more responsible fishing or hunting / inspire others to help]	

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Marking Criteria for Question 4

Table F, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2, R3 and R5.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• The response reveals a thorough evaluation and analysis of the text. • A wide range of ideas is applied. • Developed ideas are sustained and well related to the text. • There is supporting detail throughout, which is well integrated into the response, contributing to a strong sense of purpose and approach. • All three bullets are well covered. • A consistent and convincing voice is used.
4	7–8	• The response demonstrates a competent reading of the text with some evidence of basic evaluation or analysis. • A good range of ideas is evident. • Some ideas are developed but the ability to sustain them may not be consistent. • There is frequent, helpful supporting detail, contributing to a clear sense of purpose. • All three bullets are covered. • An appropriate voice is used.
3	5–6	• The response shows that the text has been read reasonably well. • A range of straightforward ideas is offered. • Opportunities for development are rarely taken. • Supporting detail is present but there may be some mechanical use of the text. • There is uneven focus on the bullets. • The voice is plain.
2	3–4	• There is some evidence of general understanding of the main ideas, but the response lacks focus on the text or the task. • Some brief, straightforward reference to the text is made. • There may be some reliance on lifting from the text. • Limited focus on the bullets. • The voice might be inappropriate.
1	1–2	• There is very limited evidence of engagement with the text. • Content is either insubstantial or unselective. • There is little realisation of the need to modify material from the text.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Table G, Writing

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Writing. This question tests assessment objectives W1, W2, W3 and W4.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• Effective style. • Carefully structured for benefit of the reader. • Wide range of vocabulary, used with precision. • Effective use of language for audience and purpose.
4	7–8	• Sometimes effective style, mostly fluent and clear. • Ideas generally well sequenced. • Range of vocabulary, used with some precision. • Sometimes effective use of language for audience and purpose.
3	5–6	• Clear, plain style. • Relies on the sequence of the original text. • Range of vocabulary is adequate. • Some awareness of audience and purpose.
2	3–4	• Inconsistent style, expression sometimes awkward. • Response is not well sequenced. • Vocabulary is simple, limited in range or reliant on the original text. • Limited awareness of audience and purpose.
1	1–2	• Expression unclear. • Very brief and undeveloped. • Copies sections from the original text. • Little attempt to explain ideas.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024